

Fig. 3: Schematic symbol wizard

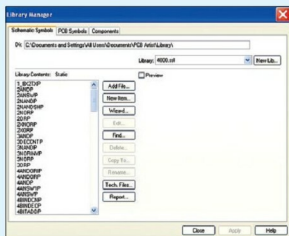


Fig. 4: Library manager

PCB file format or saved as templates. PCB Artist provides excellent image quality and a handy set of parameters to help you create digital electronic circuits and schemas.

### Ease of use

One of the major factors which differentiate PCB Artist from other tools is that it offers a step-by-step approach for any process, from designing circuits to final PCB design, in an integrated manner.

If you are a beginner, you can just follow the intuitive steps and build your project. For example, PCB setup wizard will guide you through different steps, such as setting the board parameters, specifying design require-

ments, layers and finalising the PCB. Similarly, the schematic symbol wizard includes steps to specify technology, type, style and pins.

Also, PCB Artist offers you flexibility in the designing process. All the components can be added to the working environment with just a few clicks, and you can preview each object in a dedicated pane.

The basic editing operations (such as cut, copy, paste or delete) and others (such as undo or redo actions, selection of a colour for the board, connections and highlighted sections, zooming in or out, as well as insertion of various objects such as rectangles, triangles, closed shapes, squares and single lines) give you flexibility in the designing process and make the software user friendly.

Besides, you can add pads, connections and tracking lines, embed text messages, identify electrical spacing errors, measure the distance between two points or items and add copper shapes.

## A feature-rich and powerful tool

If we compare PCB Artist to its various other competitors, we will find

that PCB Artist is a feature-rich and powerful tool. It offers an integrated solution for schematics and PCB layout in a single application. No other application, whether free or paid, offers this large number of features as offered by the PCB Artist.

Schematic symbol, footprint, part, creation wizards with parts list reports in CSV (Excel) format are a few unique features of this tool. It also allows for component auto renumber in copy and paste, single-side AutoRouting and much more.

PCBs are the main elements of any electronics manufacturing, so knowledge of PCB layout tools can be a vital skill. PCB Artist has almost no flaws. The step-by-step approach provides a clear understanding of the process, making this tool powerful and useful for educational purpose as well.

## System requirements

PCB Artist runs on Windows operating systems; either Windows XP or Vista is recommended. Windows 95 or earlier, Linux and MAC OS are not currently supported. It is a lightweight resource-friendly tool which does not particularly require 'high-powered' hardware to achieve good performance and can run perfectly on older systems as well.

## Support

PCB Artist can be downloaded for free at [www.4pcb.com](http://www.4pcb.com). There are step-by-step PCB design tutorials available on the website to get started, which will help you to create your own designs faster than you ever imagined. You can visit <http://www.4pcb.com/book/index.html> for the online PCB Artist User Guide. ●

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